Stellarr

Version 1.0, draft

Brand guidelines

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Talk on your own server.

What it is

Self-hosted text and voice chat for small groups who already know each other. One Docker image runs all of it.

The scene

Four or five friends, talking late in the evening from ordinary rooms. A lit desk in a dark room: the conversation is the lit part.

The character

Precise, quiet, dependable, warm at the edges. Never playful, gamified, corporate or futuristic.

Principles

The conversation comes first.

Navigation stays subordinate to what people are saying.

State is clear without colour.

Connection, microphone and presence always carry a shape and a word.

Standard beats decorative.

Familiar behaviour matters more than originality for its own sake.

It works right away.

A small private instance needs none of the setup of a large platform.

Web and desktop are equal.

Every feature has to be useful in both.

What Stellarr is not

- ✕ Neon gaming interfaces
- ✕ Gradient text and decorative gradients
- ✕ Too many cards
- ✕ Big empty dashboards
- ✕ Animation unrelated to a change of state
- ✕ Emoji as interface icons

Tone of voice

Stellarr talks like a capable friend who runs the server: plain, exact and unbothered.

English is the base language. Polish is a full translation written to read naturally, and its status words avoid gendered adjectives. Write in sentence case. No exclamation marks and no emoji in the interface. Stellarr is one word with a capital S.

Say what happened, then what to do.

✓ The message could not be sent. Try again. A problem has a cause and a next step.	✗ Oops! Something went wrong.
✓ Too many attempts. Wait a moment and try again. Stay calm at the moment something fails.	✗ Whoa, slow down there!
✓ Changes apply immediately, including during a call, without disconnecting. Be exact about what happens.	✗ Your settings have been seamlessly updated.
✓ Lower detects only clear, voiced speech. Higher also catches whispers. Technical is welcome. Explain the effect.	✗ Adjust the VAD threshold.
✓ Delete this message? This cannot be undone. Name the consequence, once.	✗ Are you sure? You might regret this!
✓ You have no notifications An empty list needs no personality.	✗ Nothing to see here yet, check back soon!

Talk on your own server.

Descriptor

Self-hosted text and voice chat for small groups.

Short description

Stellarr is self-hosted text and voice chat for small groups who already know each other. One Docker image runs all of it. Messages and files stay on your server, and calls need no third-party media service.

Words we use

Stellarr
One word, capital S, double r at the end. Never all capitals.

instance
One installation of Stellarr, as in your Stellarr instance.

server, channel, call
What people see inside an instance. A voice channel holds a call.

log in, log out
The verbs for accounts, instead of sign in and sign out.

Buttons
Name the action: Send, Join the call, Try again.

In progress
A verb and an ellipsis character: Logging in…, Opening…

Logo and mascot

A solid speech bubble holding the three-bar meter that shows who is speaking. Text and voice in one shape.



Stellarr



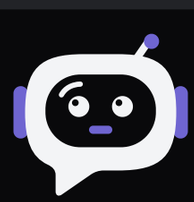
The astronaut

The helmet is the same speech bubble as the logo, so the two read as one family.

The mascot appears in empty states, onboarding and error screens. It never replaces the logo. Each face matches a state in the app and always appears with its word.



Speaking



Idle



Listening



Happy



Microphone off



Away



Connecting...



Connection failed

Using the logo

Give the logo room, keep it whole, and use the right drawing for the size.

Clear space
x on every side, where x is the height of the shortest bar

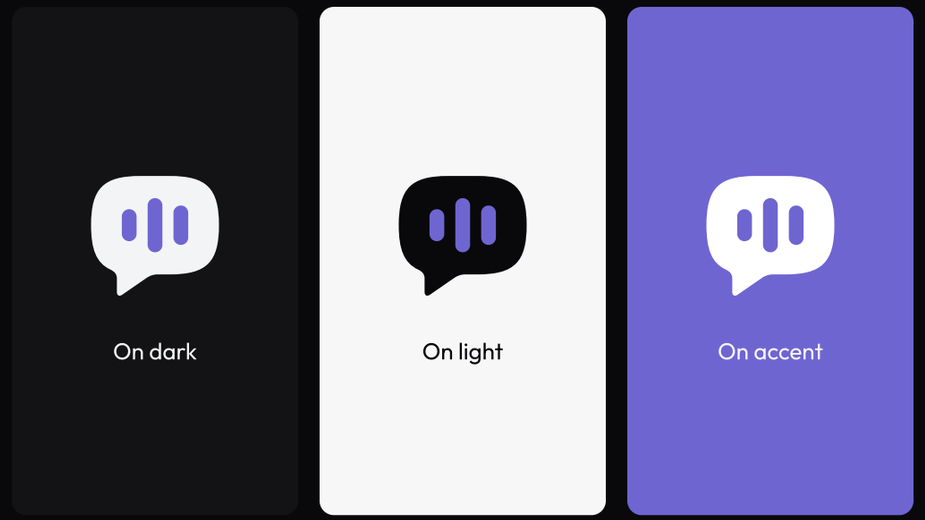
Primary drawing
48 px and up

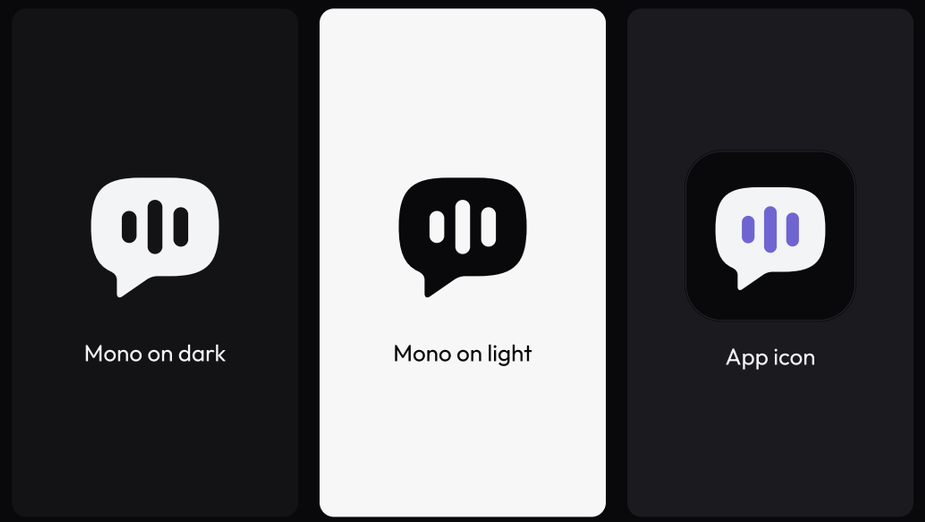
Small drawing
16 to 47 px, with wider bars and a fuller body

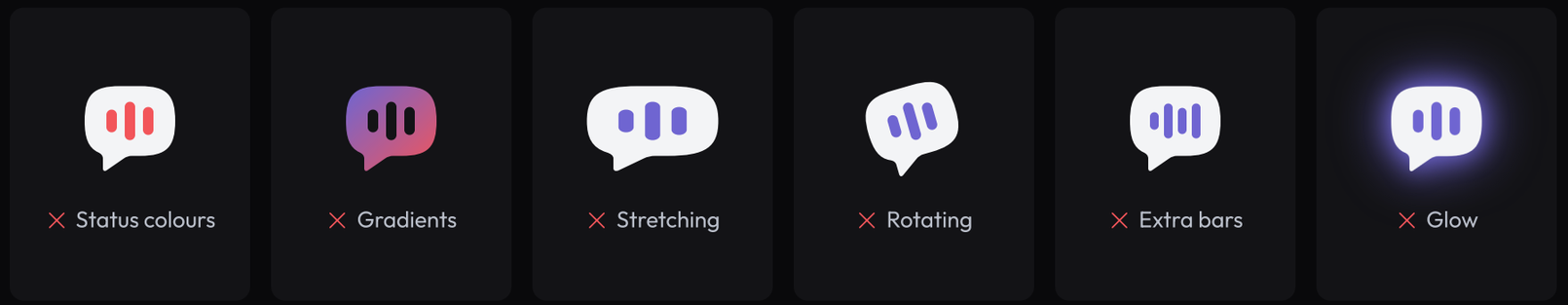
Minimum size
16 px on screen

App icon
The mark on its own tile, on Darkest









Lockups and colour

The mark and the name, set in Outfit SemiBold. The gap between them equals x, the height of the shortest bar.

Stellarr

Horizontal, the default

Stellarr

Stacked, for square spaces

Stellarr

Talk on your own server.

With the tagline

Stellarr

Darkest

Stellarr

Primary

Stellarr

Accent

Stellarr

Light

Stellarr

One colour, dark

Stellarr

One colour, light

The astronaut

A small companion for the moments when the interface has nothing else to show.

Use it for

Empty states

Onboarding and first-run screens

Errors, next to a clear next step

Stickers and community posts

Never

In place of the logo or app icon

Inside buttons or navigation

As the only sign of a state, with no word beside it

In a confirmation that deletes something



You have no notifications

Invitations and durable extension events will remain available here.

Empty state, idle



Check microphone

Say something. The meter shows what the app hears and lights up when it detects speech.

Onboarding, speaking



The server could not be loaded

Check your connection and try again in a moment.

Try again

Error, connection failed



✕ Recolouring



✕ Stretching



✕ Glow



✕ Tilting

Stellarr indigo

#6f65d1

OKLCH	0.570 0.161 284
White text on accent	4.71:1
On Darkest	4.22:1
On Primary	3.33:1

Midnight

Warm graphite and one calm indigo. Accent marks actions and live state, on at most three elements at once.

Surfaces

- Darkest #09090b
- Floating #101113
- Dark #18181b
- Tertiary #1e1f23
- Primary #222327
- Hover #27272a
- Active #33343a

Text

- Normal #f3f4f6
- Muted #b9bec9
- Faint, small text #9aa0ad
- Faint, decorative #747b89

Lines

- Default #292e39
- Subtle white .06
- Strong white .2

Status

- Success #3dd68c
- Warning #f0b232
- Danger #f2555a
- Info #6ea8fe

Colour in use

Accent means live or actionable. Everything else stays neutral.

Accent is for

The primary action

An open connection

The person speaking

Accent is not for

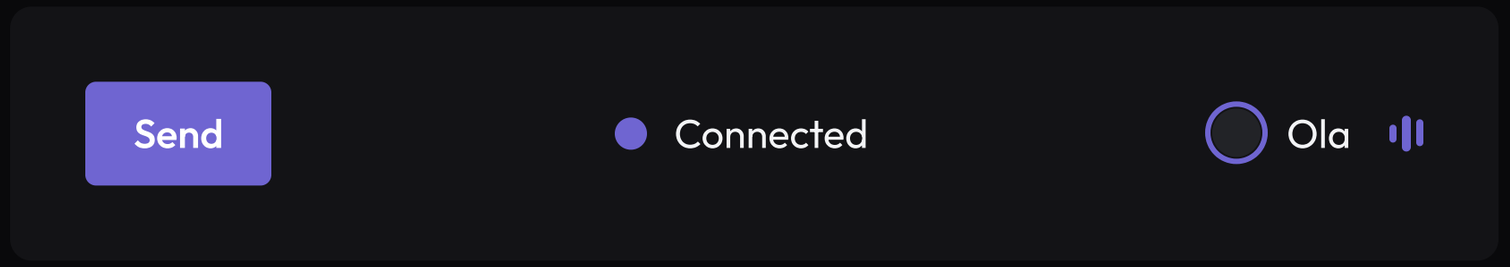
Channel selection

Headings and decoration

Destructive controls, which use Danger

Text on an accent fill is black or white, whichever measures higher. With Stellarr indigo that is white.

At most three at once



If a fourth element wants the accent, something else is wrong.

Six themes

Each theme defines every colour role. A theme is named for how it looks, in one plain English word, and never after a company or a product.

Midnight

`midnight`

Warm graphite and a calm indigo. The default.

Joining the call in ten minutes.

Send

Slate

`slate`

Cool graphite with the same indigo.

Joining the call in ten minutes.

Send

Evergreen

`evergreen`

A green accent on neutral, near-black surfaces.

Joining the call in ten minutes.

Send

Harbor

`harbor`

Steel blue on deep navy surfaces.

Joining the call in ten minutes.

Send

Amethyst

`amethyst`

Vivid violet on neutral black surfaces.

Joining the call in ten minutes.

Send

Ink

`ink`

Graphite navy with a clear blue accent.

Joining the call in ten minutes.

Send

Outfit

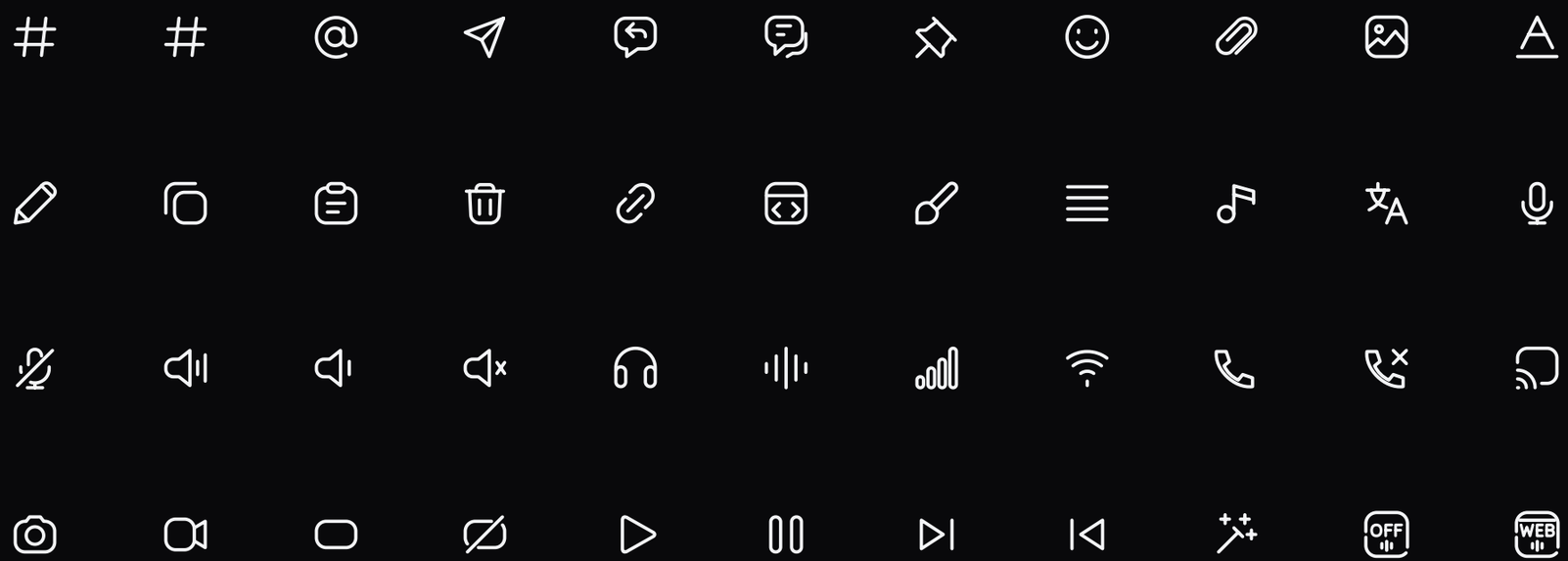
AaBbCcDdEeFfGgHhIiJjKkLlMmNnOoPpQqRrSsTt
UuVvWwXxYyZz ĄąĆćĘęŁłŃńÓóŚśŹźŻż
0123456789

Log in	28 / 1.2 / 600	Login screen
Late shift	20 / 1.25 / 600	Instance name
general	16 / 1.4 / 550	Channel, dialog title
Joining the call in ten minutes.	15 / 1.6 / 400	Message text
Lounge	13 / 1.5 / 450	Rail, buttons
21:14	12 / 1.5 / 450	Times, captions
VOICE	11 / 1.5 / 600	Group captions
#6f65d1	13 / 1.5 / 400	Code, in JetBrains Mono

87 icons

Drawn for Stellarr on a 24-unit grid with a 1.5 stroke and round ends. Every icon takes the colour of its control.

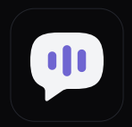
Corners and bars come from the mark. Each noise reduction mode carries its short label, because that reads best at 24 px.



In use



App icon



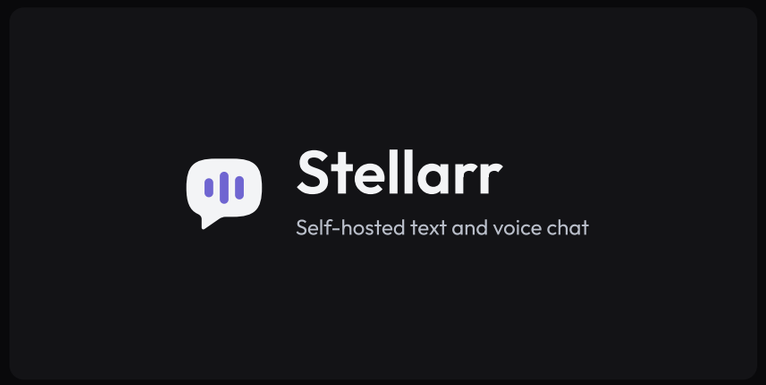
64



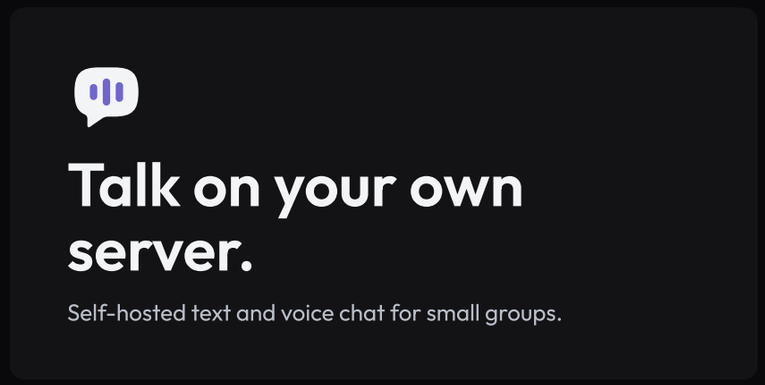
32



Browser tab, 16



README header, 1280 x 320



Repository preview card, 1280 x 640

Name and logo

The code is MIT licensed. That covers the code and does not grant rights to the name or the mark. Draft, without legal review.

You can

Run Stellarr, changed or unchanged, for your own group.

Use the name and mark when writing about the project.

Say your work is based on Stellarr.

Ask first

Using the mark on a hosted service you charge for, or on merchandise.

Please don't

Publish a fork under the Stellarr name or mark.

Suggest the project endorses your product.

Alter the mark and present it as official.



Questions? Open an issue in the repository.

Version 1.0, draft, 10 November 2026